

HiSD Package: SaddleScape V-1.0

A Python package for constructing solution landscapes using High-index Saddle Dynamics (HiSD). This toolkit enables numerical computation of saddle points and their hierarchical organization in dynamical systems. It simplifies the process of saddle point searching, offers flexible parameter settings and many visualization tools.

Installation & Import

Step 1: Download the Code First, download the code from GitHub:

- **GitHub Repository:** <https://github.com/HiSDpackage/saddlescape>

Step 2: Add the `saddlescape-1.0` Directory to the System Path After downloading the code, you need to add the path of the `saddlescape-1.0` directory to the system path. This will allow you to access the package from anywhere on your system.

Use the following Python code to add the directory to the system path:

```
import sys
sys.path.append('/path/to/saddlescape-1.0')
```

Replace `'/path/to/saddlescape-1.0'` with the actual path where the `saddlescape-1.0` directory is located.

Step 3: Import the Main Class Once the path is set, you can import the main class `Landscape` from the `SaddleScape` package as follows:

```
from saddlescape import Landscape
```

This will allow you to use the `Landscape` class and other functionalities provided by the package.

Configuration Parameters

The configuration parameters for the `SaddleScape` package are divided into different categories, each focusing on a specific part of the algorithm. Below is an overview of the different categories and the associated parameters.

System Parameters

These parameters are related to the system setup and its general properties: `Dim`, `EnergyFunction`, `Grad`, `AutoDiff`, `NumericalGrad`, `DimerLength`, `SymmetryCheck` and `GradientSystem`.

Dim (Optional)

Description

System dimension specification.

Data Type

`int` (positive)

Behavior

- Default: Inferred from `InitialPoint`
- Manual override must match dimensions of:
 - `InitialPoint`
 - `InitialSearchDirection`

EnergyFunction (Conditional Required)

Description

Specifies the energy function for gradient systems.

Data Type

- Python function: `Callable[[np.ndarray], float]`
 - **Input:** `np.ndarray` with shape `(d, 1)` (column vector)
- Symbolic expression: `str`
 - **Specification:** Use `x1`, `x2`, ..., `xd` as variables & Supports full `sympy` syntax

Example

```
EnergyFunction = '''
0.4*x1**2 - 0.2*x1*x2 + 0.25*x2**2
- 5*(atan(x1-5) + atan(x2-5))
'''
```

Grad (Conditional Required)

Description

Specifies the gradient function for gradient systems or vector field for non-gradient systems.

Requirements

- For gradient systems: ∇E
- For non-gradient systems: Direct specification of F in $\dot{x} = -F(x)$

Data Types

- Python function: `Callable[[np.ndarray], np.ndarray]`
 - **Input/Output:** `np.ndarray` with shape `(d, 1)` (column vector)
- Symbolic expression list: `list[str]` (e.g., `["2*x1", "cos(x2)"]`)

Example

```
# Gradient system
Grad = ["2*x1", "2*x2"]

# Non-gradient system
Grad = ["x2", "-x1 - 0.1*x2"]
```

AutoDiff (Optional)

Description

Enables automatic differentiation of the energy function.

Data Type

bool

Options

- **True**: Requires **EnergyFunction** parameter
- **False**: Requires manual specification of **Grad** parameter

Behavior

- Defaults to **True** if **EnergyFunction** is provided
- Defaults to **False** if **Grad** is provided

NumericalGrad (Optional)

Description

Enables numerical gradient approximation.

Applicability

Only active when **Grad** is unspecified

Data Type

bool

Options

- **True**: Use finite difference approximation
- **False**: (Default) Use analytical gradient from **EnergyFunction**

DimerLength (Optional)

Description

Displacement length for numerical gradient approximations.

Data Type

float (positive)

Default

1e-5

SymmetryCheck (Optional)

Description

Verifies gradient system properties via Hessian symmetry.

Data Type

bool

Behavior

- **True**: (default) Auto-detect
 - **False**: Bypass checks (improves performance)
-

GradientSystem (Optional)

Description

Explicit declaration of gradient system nature.

Usage

Override automatic detection when known a priori.

Data Type

bool

Behavior

- missing: Auto-detect
-

Hessian Parameters

These parameters are related to the Hessian matrix: **ExactHessian** and **HessianDimerLength**.

ExactHessian (Optional)

Description

Controls Hessian matrix computation method.

Data Type

bool

Options

- **True**: Analytical Hessian from symbolic gradient
- **False**: (Default) Dimer-based approximation

Requirement

Requires **Grad** as symbolic expressions

HessianDimerLength (Optional)

Description

Displacement length for numerical Hessian-Vector product approximations.

Data Type

float (positive)

Default

1e-5

Eigen Parameters

These parameters control how the eigen pairs (eigenvalues and eigenvectors) are computed: EigenMethod, EigenMaxIter, EigenStepSize and PrecisionTol.

EigenMethod (Optional)

Description

Eigensolver selection for stability analysis.

Data Type

str

Options

Method	System Type	Description
lobpcg	Gradient (Default)	Locally Optimal Block PCG
euler	Gradient & Non-gradient	Explicit Euler Discretization
power	Non-gradient (Default)	Power Method

EigenMaxIter (Optional)

Description

Maximum iterations for eigenpair computation.

Data Type

int (positive)

Default

10

EigenStepSize (Optional)

Description

Discretization step for Euler/power methods.

Data Type

float (positive)

Default

1e-7

PrecisionTol (Optional)

Description

Precision tolerance for eigenvalues. (We treat eigenvalues as 0 if its absolute value less than tolerance.)

Data Type

`float` (non-negative)

Default

`1e-5`

EigvecUnified (Optional)

Description

Ensures eigenvectors corresponding to multiple eigenvalues are unified across different computational devices.

Explanation Due to significant differences in the implementation of fundamental algorithms (e.g., LAPACK) across hardware platforms, eigenvectors for multiple eigenvalues may vary substantially between devices, even though they all form valid bases for the same eigenspace. When set to `True`, this parameter activates Gaussian elimination to obtain the Row-Echelon Form (REF), followed by Gram-Schmidt orthogonalization. This process standardizes the basis vectors of the eigenspace, thereby improving cross-device search stability.

Note: Outputs may still vary between devices due to differences in rounding error simulation.

Data Type

`bool`

Default

`False`

Acceleration Parameters

These parameters are related to improving the speed and efficiency of the algorithm: `BBStep`, `Acceleration`, `NesterovChoice`, `NesterovRestart` and `Momentum`.

BBStep (Optional)

Description

Enables Barzilai-Borwein adaptive step sizing.

Data Type

`bool`

Default

`False`

Trade-off

- May accelerate convergence
 - Can cause instability in stiff systems
-

Acceleration (Optional)**Description**

Convergence acceleration technique.

Data Type `str`

Options

- `none`: (Default) No acceleration
- `heavyball`: Momentum-based acceleration
- `nesterov`: Nesterov-accelerated dynamics

NesterovChoice (Optional)**Description**

Specifies the acceleration parameter sequence for Nesterov's method.

Data Type

`int`

Options

- `1`: (default) $\gamma_n = \frac{n}{n+3}$.
- `2`: $\gamma_n = \frac{\theta_n-1}{\theta_{n+1}}$, with $\theta_{n+1} = \frac{1+\sqrt{1+4\theta_n^2}}{2}$, $\theta_0 = 1$.

Default

`1`

NesterovRestart (Optional)**Description**

Iteration interval for Nesterov momentum reset.

Data Type

`int` (positive) | `None`

Behavior

- `None`: Disables momentum restart
- Integer `n`: Resets momentum every `n` iterations

Default

`None`

Momentum (Optional)**Description**

Momentum coefficient for heavy ball acceleration.

Data Type

`float` (non-negative)

Default`0.0`**Constraints**

- `0.0 <= Momentum < 1.0`
- `0.0`: Equivalent to no acceleration

Solver Parameters

These parameters are related to the solver process and control the behavior of the HiSD process:

`InitialPoint`, `Tolerance`, `SearchArea`, `TimeStep`, `MaxIter`, `SaveTrajectory`, `Verbose`, `ReportInterval`, `CustomTD` and `CustomTD Step`.

`InitialPoint` (Required)**Description**

The starting coordinates for saddle point search.

Data Types

`list` | `numpy.ndarray` (1D array)

Example

`InitialPoint = [0.5, -1.2]`

`Tolerance` (Optional)**Description**

Convergence threshold for saddle point iterations.

Data Type

`float` (positive)

Default

`1e-6`

Stopping Criterion

$Vert$ gradient vector $Vert_2 < Tolerance$

`SearchArea` (Optional)**Description**

Maximum exploration radius from initial point.

Data Type

`float` (positive)

Default

`1e3`

Effect

Terminates search if $\|x - x_{0}\|_2 > SearchArea$

TimeStep (Optional)**Description**

Temporal discretization interval for dynamics.

Data Type

float (positive)

Default

1e-4

MaxIter (Optional)**Description**

Maximum number of HiSD iterations permitted.

Data Type

int (positive)

Default

1000

SaveTrajectory (Optional)**Description**

Records full optimization path during computation.

Data Type

bool

Default

True

Verbose (Optional)**Description**

Controls real-time progress reporting.

Output

Prints iteration count and gradient norm.

Data Type

bool

Default

False

ReportInterval (Optional)**Description**

Iteration frequency for console output when `Verbose=True`.

Data Type`int` (positive)**Default**

100

CustomTD (Optional)**Description**

User-defined temporal discretization function.

- **None**: Use the built-in update scheme.
- **Callable**: Apply custom update using histories of `x`, `v`, and gradients. **Signature**:
`CustomTD(instance, xlist, vlist, glist, dt, j)*`

Data TypesNone | `Callable`**Default**

None

CustomTD Step (Optional)**Description**History length retained for `CustomTD`.

- **None**: Keep all history.
- **int(positive)**: Keep the latest `CustomTD Step` steps. Set this value if the user wishes to employ `CustomTD` without retaining the full history.

Data TypesNone | `int(positive)`**Default**

None

Landscape Parameters

These parameters are related to constructing and navigating the solution landscape: `MaxIndex`, `MaxIndexGap`, `SameJudgementMethod`, `InitialEigenVectors`, `PerturbationMethod`, `PerturbationRadius`, `PerturbationNumber` and `EigenCombination`.

MaxIndex (Optional)**Description**Maximum saddle index (`k`) to compute.

- Index 0: Uses standard SD (Steepest Descent) method
- Index ≥ 1 : Uses HiSD (High-index Saddle Dynamics) method

Data Type`int` (non-negative)

Default

6

Constraints

$0 \leq \text{max_index} \leq \text{Dim}$

MaxIndexGap (Optional)

Description

Maximum allowed index difference between parent and child saddle points during hierarchical search.

Data Type

int (positive)

Default

1

Example

If `MaxIndexGap = 2`:

- Parent (index 4) --> Children (indices 2, 3)
 - Parent (index 3) --> Children (indices 1, 2)
-

SameJudgementMethod (Optional)

Description

Saddle point equivalence criterion.

Data Types

- float (positive): Threshold for 2-norm distance (default: 1e-3)
- Callable[[np.ndarray, np.ndarray], bool]: Custom comparison function
 - Input: np.ndarray with shape (d, 1) (column vector)

Example

```
# Custom similarity check
def custom_judge(a, b):
    return np.linalg.norm(a - b) < 0.5 and abs(a[0] - b[0]) < 0.1
```

InitialEigenvectors (Optional)

Description

Initial guess for Hessian eigenvectors.

Data Types

- None: (Default) Auto-initialize with k smallest eigenvectors
- Manual input: np.ndarray of shape (d, k)
where d is the dimension and k equals MaxIndex.

Requirement

Column vectors must be orthonormal

PerturbationMethod (Optional)

Description

Statistical distribution for saddle point exploration.

Data Type

str

Options

Value	Description
uniform (Default)	Uniform sampling
gaussian	Normally distributed displacements

PerturbationRadius (Optional)

Description

Displacement magnitude for saddle perturbations.

Data Type

float (positive)

Default

1e-4

PerturbationNumber (Optional)

Description

Number of directional probes per saddle point.

Note

Actual probes = 2 * PerturbationNumber (bidirectional)

Data Type

int (positive)

Default

2

EigenCombination (Optional)

Description

Strategy for eigenvector utilization in perturbations.

Data Type

str

Options

Value	Computational Cost	Completeness
<code>all</code> (Default)	High	Exhaustive
<code>min</code>	Low	Partial

Execution Interface

`.Run()`

Description

Initiates the solution landscape computation process.

Parameters

None

Usage

```
landscape = Landscape(
    MaxIndex=3,
    AutoDiff=True,
    EnergyFunction="1*(x1**2-1)**2+2*(x2**2-1)**2+3*(x3**2-1)**2",
    InitialPoint=np.array([0, 0, 0])
)
landscape.Run() # Starts computation
```

Output

Access search trajectory by `instance.DetailRecord`. Each row of it is data for one successful search. sequentially contains ID of end saddle point, ID of start saddle point, ndarray of each step position and ndarray of each step time position.

Access saddle point data by `instance.SaddleList`. Each row of it is data for one saddle point. sequentially contains ID of the saddle point, position of the saddle point, Morse Index of the saddle point, the eigenvectors of negative eigenvalues and set of father saddles.

See [Output Objects](#) for more details.

`.RestartFromPoint(RestartPoint, MaxIndex)`

Description

Restarts computation from specified coordinates.

Parameters

Name	Type	Constraints	Description
<code>RestartPoint</code>	<code>list</code> or <code>numpy.ndarray</code> (1D)	Must match system dimension	Initial position vector

Name	Type	Constraints	Description
MaxIndex	int	$0 \leq \text{max_index} \leq \text{dim}$	Maximum saddle index to compute

Usage

```
landscape.RestartFromPoint(  
    RestartPoint=np.array([[0.2], [-0.8]]),  
    MaxIndex=2  
)
```

`.RestartFromSaddle(BeginID, Perturbation, MaxIndex)`

Description

Restarts computation from existing saddle point.

Parameters

Name	Type	Constraints	Description
BeginID	int	$0 \leq \text{begin_id} < \text{len}(\text{SaddleList})$	Valid saddle point ID
Perturbation	numpy.ndarray (1D)	Must match system dimension	Initial perturbation vector
MaxIndex	int	$0 \leq \text{max_index} \leq \text{dim}$	Maximum saddle index to compute

Usage

```
landscape.RestartFromSaddle(  
    BeginID=3,  
    Perturbation=1e-3 * np.array([[ -1], [ 0.5]]),  
    MaxIndex=2  
)
```

`.DrawTrajectory(**kwargs)`

Description

Visualizes search trajectories and energy landscapes for systems. Supports contour overlays, style customization, and high-D projections.

Parameters

Name	Type	Constraints	Description & Default Value
DetailedTraj	bool	Requires saved trajectory data	Show full iteration path (default: <code>False</code>)
Contour	bool	2D systems only	Enable contour lines (default: <code>True</code>)
Contourf	bool	<code>Contour=True</code>	Enable color-filled contours (default: <code>True</code>)
ContourGridNum	int	<code>>= 1</code>	Main grid divisions per axis (default: <code>50</code>)
ContourGridOut	int	<code>>= 0</code>	Extended grid divisions per axis (default: <code>10</code>)
Title	str		Figure title text (default: <code>"The Search Trajectory"</code>)
TrajectorySet	dict		Set the trajectory style (default: <code>{"linewidth": 0.4, "linestyle": "-", "color": "blue", "label": "Search Trajectory"}</code>)
SaddlePointSet	list[dict]		Set the saddle point style (default: <code>[{"marker": "o", "color": colors[20 * i + 20], "label": f"Index {i} Saddle Point"} for i in range(instance.MaxIndex + 1)]</code>)
GridSet	dict		Set the grid style (default: <code>{"visible": True, "linestyle": "--", "linewidth": 0.1, "color": "gray"}</code>)
1DSamples	int	<code>>= 1</code> (1D only)	Function sampling density (default: <code>1e3</code>)
1DSamplesOut	int	<code>>= 0</code> (1D only)	Extended sampling range (default: <code>1e2</code>)
1DFunctionDraw	dict	1D only	Set the 1D function style (default: <code>{"linewidth": 2, "linestyle": "-", "color": "red", "label": "Function Curve"}</code>)
WhetherSave	bool		Save to file (default: <code>False</code>)
SaveFigurePath	str	File extension determines format	Output path (default: <code>"Landscape_figure.png"</code>)

Name	Type	Constraints	Description & Default Value
Projection	None or callable	Required for dim > 2	Projection function (Signature: ((n*dim) array) --> ((n*2) array))

Usage

```
# 2D system without detailed trajectory
landscape.DrawTrajectory(
    Contour=True,
    Contourf=True,
    WhetherSave=True,
    ContourGridNum=100,
    ContourGridOut=25,
    SaveFigurePath="landscape.png"
)

# high-D system with detailed trajectory
import numpy as np
def proj_func(input):
    output = np.hstack((1.0 * input[:, [0]]+ 1.5 * input[:, [1]], 1.0 * input[:, [0]]+ 2.5 * input[:, [2]]))
    return output

landscape.DrawTrajectory(
    DetailedTraj=True,
    ContourGridNum=100,
    ContourGridOut=25,
    Projection=proj_func
)
```

Visualization Rules

Dimensionality Handling:

- 1D: X-axis = iteration count, Y-axis = function value
- 2D: Natural coordinates
- =3D: Requires Projection to 2D plane

Data Requirements

- Detailed trajectories require SaveTrajectory=True in .Run() call

Output

- Matplotlib figure (interactive display)
- Image file when WhetherSave=True (PNG/PDF/SVG based on path)

.DrawConnection(**kwargs)

Description

Visualizes connectivity between saddle points in the solution landscape. Displays markers for saddle nodes and search paths connecting them. Supports custom styling of points and connection lines.

Parameters

Name	Type	Default Value	Description
Title	str	"The Connection of Saddle Points"	Figure title text
SaddlePointSet	list[dict]	[{"node_shape": "o", "node_color": colors[i], "label": f"Index {i} Saddle Point"}for i in range(instance.MaxIndex + 1)]	Set the saddle point style
TrajectorySet	dict	{"width": 0.4, "style": "solid", "edge_color": "blue", "label": "Search Trajectory"}	Set the connection path style
WhetherSave	bool	False	Save to file
SaveFigurePath	str	"Landscape_Connection_figure.png"	Output path (file extension determines format)

Usage

```
# Draw solution landscape
landscape.DrawConnection(
    Title="Solution Landscape",
    WhetherSave=True,
    SaveFigurePath="landscape.png"
)
```

.Save(filepath, fileformat)

Description

Persists calculation results to persistent storage with specified serialization format.

Parameters

Name	Type	Constraints	Description
filepath	str	Valid filesystem path	Target path without extension
fileformat	str	"json" "pickle" "mat" (default: "json")	Serialization format

Usage

```
landscape.Save(filepath="/output/results", fileformat="pickle")
```

File Output

Generates:

- `filepath.json` (JSON text format)
- `filepath.pickle` (Python binary serialization)
- `filepath.mat` (MATLAB-compatible binary)

Contains dictionary with aligned indices for:

1. `SaddleID`: Unique identification numbers
2. `Position`: Spatial coordinates (N-dimensional array)
3. `MorseIndex`: Number of negative eigenvalues
4. `FatherSet`: Ancestry relationships (list-formatted references)

Index Consistency

All data structures maintain identical ordering:

`SaddleID[n]` - `Position[n]` - `MorseIndex[n]` - `FatherSet[n]`

Output Objects

`.SaddleList`

Description

Collection of discovered saddle points with topological metadata.

Type

`list[list]`

Node Structure

```
[
  [
    ID: int,                # Index 0 - Unique identifier
    Position: np.ndarray,   # Index 1 - Coordinate vector (d-dim)
    Morse Index: int,       # Index 2 - Number of negative eigenvalues
    Unstable Directions: np.ndarray, # Index 3 - Eigenvectors (d x k)
    Parent IDs: list[int]   # Index 4 - Ancestor saddle IDs (where -1 indicates
                           initial point)
  ]
  ... # Other saddle points
]
```

Access

```
# Get all index-1 saddles
index1_saddles = [node for node in landscape.SaddleList if node[2] == 1]

# Get position of saddle ID 5
saddle5_pos = landscape.SaddleList[5][1]
```

.DetailRecord

Description

Complete search trajectory data.

Type

list[list]

Record Structure

```
[
  [
    End ID: int,          # Index 0 - Terminating saddle ID
    Start ID: int,        # Index 1 - Originating saddle ID
    Path Positions: np.ndarray, # Index 2 - Trajectory points (N x d)
    Path Times: np.ndarray   # Index 3 - Temporal coordinates (N x 1)
  ]
  ... # Other search trajectory
]
```

Access

```
# Plot first search path
first_search = landscape.DetailRecord[0]
plt.plot(first_search[2][:,0], first_search[2][:,1])
```

Package Requirements

Overview

This component requires the following Python packages to be installed. Verify installations before usage.

Built-in Packages

The following standard library modules are required (no installation needed):

```
import copy
import sys
```

```
import warnings
import json
import itertools
import math
import pickle
```

Third-party Dependencies

Required external packages with version specifications:

Package	Required Version	Installation Command
NumPy	2.2.6	<code>pip install numpy==2.2.6</code>
SciPy	1.15.3	<code>pip install scipy==1.15.3</code>
SymPy	1.14.0	<code>pip install sympy==1.14.0</code>
Matplotlib	3.10.5	<code>pip install matplotlib==3.10.5</code>
NetworkX	3.4.2	<code>pip install networkx==3.4.2</code>

Full Environment Setup

```
pip install "numpy==2.2.6" "scipy==1.15.3" "sympy==1.14.0" "matplotlib==3.10.5"
"networkx==3.4.2"
```

Version Verification

Check installed versions using:

```
import numpy, scipy, sympy, matplotlib, networkx

print(f"NumPy: {numpy.__version__}")      # Should show 2.2.6
print(f"SciPy: {scipy.__version__}")      # Should show 1.15.3
print(f"SymPy: {sympy.__version__}")      # Should show 1.14.0
print(f"Matplotlib: {matplotlib.__version__}") # Should show 3.10.5
print(f"NetworkX: {networkx.__version__}") # Should show 3.4.2
```